

Xiaoxue LENG

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EDUCATION

- 2025-2030 (Expected) **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (UNC), Chapel Hill, NC**
Ph.D. Student in Education (Learning Sciences and Psychological Studies)
Advisor: Dr. Matthew Bernacki
- 2021-2024 **Central China Normal University (CCNU), Wuhan, China**
M.Ed. in Psychology
Thesis: *The effects of viewing perspective in learning from instructional videos which demonstrate a step-by-step procedure*
Advisor: Dr. Fuxing Wang
- 2017-2021 **Central China Normal University, Wuhan, China**
B.S. in Psychology with Honors

PUBLICATIONS

*Note. * indicates co-first author; # indicates corresponding author.*

Journal Articles in English (N = 12)

- He, G., Lin, H., **Leng, X.**, & Su, A. (2026) How to evaluate students' mathematical modeling competencies: Construction and verification of a new evaluation framework for mathematical modeling competencies. *Current Psychology*, 45, 1254. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12144-026-09769-0>
- Lin, H., Ding, J., **Leng, X.**, He, G., Lin, Y., & Zheng, H. (2026). Reciprocal relationships between perceived teachers' moral grandstanding, self-esteem, and rumination among Chinese primary school students: An RI-CLPM Study. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-026-02381-2>
- Leng, X.**, Wu, Y., Zhang, Q., & Wang, F. (2026). How does gesture mimicry improve children's memory on spatial information?. *Learning and Instruction*, 104, 102388. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.learninstruc.2026.102388>
- Wang, Y.*, **Leng, X.***, He, G., & Lin, H. (2026). When labels matter more: Behavioral and eye-tracking evidence on aesthetic judgment of AI-generated and human-created paintings by lay viewers. *Empirical Studies of the Arts*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02762374261441560>
- Lin, H.*, **Leng, X.***, Li, Y., & Wang, Y. (2026). Beauty lost in AI: Diminished aesthetic judgments of AI paintings among Chinese viewers. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*. 1–22. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2026.2621277>
- Zhu, W., **Leng, X.**, Mayer, R. E., & Wang, F. (2025). No need for webcams with synchronous online learning. *Learning and Instruction*, 98, 102131. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.learninstruc.2025.102131>

- Wang, F., **Leng, X.**, Kuang, Z., & Zhao, T. (2024). Eye movement modelling examples as cues to guide attention and improve learning in short or long animations. *Journal of Computer Assisted Learning*, 41, e13094. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcal.13094>
- Leng, X.**, Zhu, W., Mayer, R. E., & Wang, F. (2024). The viewing perspective effect in learning from instructional videos: A replication and neuroimaging extension. *Learning and Instruction*, 94, 102004. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.learninstruc.2024.102004>
- Li, W., Kuang, Z., **Leng, X.**, Mayer, R. E., & Wang, F. (2024). Role of gesturing onscreen instructors in video lectures: A set of three-level meta-analyses on the embodiment effect. *Educational Psychology Review*, 36(67). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10648-024-09910-0>
- Leng, X.**, Wang, F., Mayer, R. E., & Zhao, T. (2024). How to train students to engage in text-picture integration for multimedia lessons. *British Journal of Educational Technology*, 55(3), 1167–1188. <https://doi.org/10.1111/bjet.13419>
- Kuang, Z., Jiang, X., Shubeck, K., **Leng, X.**, Li, Y., Zhang, R., Wang, Z., Peng, S., & Hu, X. (2024). The effect of different question types on vicarious learning. *Educational Psychology*, 44(2), 208–226. <https://doi.org/10.1080/01443410.2024.2325589>
- Leng, X.**, Wang, F., & Mayer, R. E. (2024). Is student learning from a video lecture affected by whether the instructor wears a mask? *Applied Cognitive Psychology*, 38(1), e4169. <https://doi.org/10.1002/acp.4169>

Journal Articles in Chinese (N = 5)

- Kuang, Z., **Leng, X.**, Wang, F., & Hu, X. (2026). Graspable: The promoting effect of tracing gesture on learning. *Psychological Development and Education*, 42(2), 295–304. <https://doi.org/10.16187/j.cnki.issn1001-4918.2026.02.15>
- Wang, F., Huang, Y., Zhang, Y., Zhu, W., & **Leng, X.** (2024). Prompts affect learning-by-teaching process and learning outcome in multimedia learning. *Acta Psychologica Sinica*, 56(4), 469–481. <https://doi.org/10.3724/SP.J.1041.2024.00469>
- Wang, F., Huang, Y., **Leng, X.**, & Kuang, Z. (2023). Learning-by-teaching promotes the effect of multimedia learning: The impact of self-generated drawing. *Journal of Soochow University (Educational Science Edition)*, (3), 97–106. <https://doi.org/10.19563/j.cnki.sdj.2023.03.008>
- Cheng, M., Kuang, Z., **Leng, X.**, Zhang, Y., & Wang, F. (2023). Can learning by non-interactive teaching promote learning? *Advances in Psychological Science*, 31(5), 769–782. <https://doi.org/10.3724/SP.J.1042.2023.00769>
- Leng, X.**, Cheng, M., & Wang, F. (2022). The effects of testing and feedback on segmentation principle in video learning. *Studies of Psychology and Behavior*, 20(01), 52–58. <https://doi.org/10.12139/j.1672-0628.2022.01.008>

Conference & Presentations (N = 14)

- Yang, J., **Leng, X.**, & Lu, J. (2026, November). *Bridging innovation and evidence: A systematic literature review of AI-assisted anxiety interventions*. The 2026 Association for Educational Communications & Technology International Convention. Chicago, IL, USA.
- Yin, X., Cheng, M., **Leng, X.**, & Wang, F. (2026, April). *Explaining to the bored audience promotes learning-by-teaching*. The 2026 American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting,

Los Angeles, CA, USA.

- Cheng, M., Wang, F., & **Leng, X.** (2026, April). *Adding pedagogical agents who point or trace to children's instructional videos*. The 2026 American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, USA.
- Zhu, W., **Leng, X.**, Mayer, R. E., & Wang, F. (2025, April). *No need for webcams with synchronous online learning*. The 2025 American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, USA.
- Xiong, F., Ma, A., & **Leng, X.** (2023, November). *Understanding individual differences in reading Chinese traditional poetry using hidden Markov Models*. The International Conference on Intelligent Education and Intelligent Research 2023, Wuhan, Hubei, China.
- Leng, X.**, Kuang, Z., Wang, F., & Qiao, P. (2023, October). *The effects of tracing gesture on learning outcomes and cognitive load: Evidence from two three-level meta-analyses*. The 25th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Chengdu, Sichuan, China.
- Zhu, W., **Leng, X.**, & Wang, F. (2023, October). *Can the presence of teacher and student promote online learning?*. The 25th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Chengdu, Sichuan, China.
- Huang, Y., Zhang, Y., Zhu, W., **Leng, X.**, & Wang, F. (2023, October). *Prompts affect learning-by-teaching process and learning outcome in multimedia learning*. The 25th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Chengdu, Sichuan, China.
- Leng, X.**, Wang, F., Kuang, Z., & Zhao, T. (2023, September). *Eye movement modelling examples as cues to guide attention and improve learning in short or long animations*. The 9th China International Conference on Eye Movements, CICEM 2023, Tianjin, China.
- Leng, X.**, Zhao, T., & Wang, F. (2022, November). *The effects of eye movement modeling examples and verbal instruction in video learning*. The 24th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Xinxiang, Henan, China. [In virtual]
- Leng, X.**, Wang, F., & Zhu, W. (2022, November). *Do instructors' wearing masks affect students' learning?*. The 24th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Xinxiang, Henan, China. [In virtual]
- Cheng, M., Wang, F., & **Leng, X.** (2022, November). *Audience size on learning-by-teaching: Clarifying the social presence hypothesis*. The 24th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Xinxiang, Henan, China. [In virtual]
- Huang, Y., **Leng, X.**, Kuang, Z., & Wang, F. (2022, November). *Learning-by-teaching promotes the effect of multimedia learning: The impact of self-generated drawing*. The 24th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Xinxiang, Henan, China. [In virtual]
- Leng, X.**, Wang, F., & Cheng, M. (2021, October). *Incorporated self-test and feedback enhances learners' learning outcomes during the learning with segmentation*. The 23th National Academic Conference of Psychology, Hohhot, Inner Mongolia, China. [In virtual]

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

School of Education, UNC Chapel Hill

2026 Fall **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
EDUC 140 Source of Strength Leadership
EDUC 401 Childhood Development: Prenatal Birth to Age 12

School of Psychology, CCNU

2021 Fall, 2022 Fall, **Instructor**
2023 Fall Laboratory Safety and Advanced Instrumentation Operation
Laboratory Center

2023 Spring **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
Introduction to Psychology II

2022 Fall **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
Introduction to Psychology I

HONORS & AWARDS**Received at University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**

2025 Doctoral Merit Award
2025 The Graduate Student Support Fund
2025 Charles Templeton Scholarship

Received at Central China Normal University

2023 Second Class Scholarship
2022 Outstanding Graduate Scholarship (Third Prize)
2021, 2022 First Class Scholarship
2021 Merit-based Admission Scholarship
2021 Outstanding Graduates Award
2020-2021 National Undergraduate Training Program for Innovation and
Entrepreneurship & Student Research Training Program (10,000 RMB)
2018, 2019, 2020 Merit Student Award
2019-2020 Undergraduate Student Research Training Program (2,000 RMB)
2018, 2020 Boya Scholarship

SERVICES**Mentoring**

2026-Present Mentor, 1 Hour Project
2025-2026 Mentor, NextGen Psych Scholars Program

Editorial Experience

2019-2020 Editor, Journal of Undergraduates of Central China Normal University
(Humanities and Social Sciences Section)